Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Transcription and ear-led repertoire reconstruction from audio instead of a supplied chart

SECTION X | EAR -> MAP -> PLAY

Level 75 began with a complete chart and trained performance orchestration. Level 76 reverses the process: the player hears an unfamiliar source, discovers its structure in layers, verifies the result, and rebuilds a playable arrangement without depending on a prewritten chart.

1. Hear before naming

First identify repetition, pulse, and tonal center. Do not guess chord names while the form is still unknown.

2. Reduce before decorating

Bass motion, chord quality, rhythm, and structural melody are transcribed before fills, ornaments, and tone details.

3. Verify by reconstruction

A transcription is accepted only when the rebuilt part survives playback, reduced-texture testing, and a complete performance.

The seven-pass transcription stack

```
PASS 1  FORM        section lengths, repeats, landmarks
PASS 2  PULSE       meter, tempo, subdivision, groove
PASS 3  BASS        roots, inversions, pedal tones
PASS 4  HARMONY     chord quality, function, extensions
PASS 5  RHYTHM      exact attack/rest/tie pattern
PASS 6  MELODY      targets, contour, articulation
PASS 7  ARRANGEMENT register, texture, dynamics, cues
```

Written workload

Module	Events
A - tonal center	48
B - bass motion	72
C - chord quality	96
D - rhythm cells	128
E - melodic targets	96
F - form maps	64
G - layered lab	128
H - arrangement	96
I - verification	64
J - capstone	128
TOTAL	920

Listening discipline

Use short loops. Sing or tap the answer before touching the fretboard. Write uncertainty explicitly: root=?, quality=?, rhythm=?, inversion=? A blank is better than a confident wrong answer. Slow playback may be used after the first normal-speed pass; pitch shifting is not used until the tonal center has been estimated by ear.

SELF-STUDY SOURCE: ask a partner to perform the source cards, or record each source card once, put the page away, wait several minutes, and transcribe only from the recording.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

The transcription workflow and uncertainty notation

DO NOT SOLVE ALL LAYERS AT ONCE

THE ORDER OF QUESTIONS PREVENTS THE FRETBOARD FROM BECOMING A GUESSING MACHINE

1. FORM

How many bars? What repeats? Where is the strongest arrival?

2. PULSE

Can I clap the beat? Is the subdivision straight, swung, triplet, or sixteenth-based?

3. TONIC

Which pitch sounds finished when the excerpt stops?

4. BASS

What is the lowest structural pitch at each change?

5. QUALITY

Major, minor, dominant, diminished, suspended, or uncertain?

6. RHYTHM

Where are the contacts, rests, ties, anticipations, and releases?

7. MELODY

Which notes are structural targets and which are approaches?

8. ARRANGEMENT

What register, density, articulation, dynamics, and cue behavior define the part?

Uncertainty marks: ? = unresolved; / = two plausible answers; ( ) = optional or ornamental; ! = verified by at least two independent clues.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module A - tonal-center, cadence, and tonic-discrimination drills

12 CELLS | 48 EVENTS

SING THE TONIC BEFORE LOCATING IT ON THE GUITAR

For each four-note source, the source player performs the notes in order and stops. The transcriber sings the most stable destination, names the likely tonic, then confirms it on one string. Source player: do not reveal the label until the answer is committed.

Card	Source tones	Expected tonic	Confidence 0-2
1	E-G#-B-A	A	
2	D-B-G-C	C	
3	A-C-D-G	G	
4	F#-D-B-E	E	
5	E-C#-A-D	D	
6	G-E-C-F	F	
7	B-G#-E-A	A	
8	E-C-A-D	D	
9	F#-D#-B-E	E	
10	C#-A-F#-B	B	
11	A-F-D-G	G	
12	D-Bb-G-C	C	

Pass 2: source player omits the final tonic. Transcriber sings the missing resolution before touching the guitar.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module B - bass-motion reconstruction and inversion awareness

12 ROUTES | 72 EVENTS

TRANSCRIBE THE LOWEST STRUCTURAL VOICE BEFORE NAMING THE FULL CHORD

Each six-note bass route represents one chord per note. First write scale degrees only. Then name pitches. Finally propose a chord family. A bass note is not automatically the root: slash chords and inversions are deliberately included.

Key	Scale-degree bass	Pitch answer	Chord-root certainty
C major	1-5-6-3-4-5	C-G-A-E-F-G	
C major	1-7-6-5-4-5	C-B-A-G-F-G	
G major	1-3-4-5-6-5	G-B-C-D-E-D	
D major	1-5-6-4-2-5	D-A-B-G-E-A	
A major	1-3-4-5-6-2	A-C#-D-E-F#-B	
A minor	1-7-6-5-4-5	A-G-F-E-D-E	
E minor	1-3-6-7-4-5	E-G-C-D-A-B	
D minor	1-7-6-5-4-5	D-C-Bb-A-G-A	
F major	1-3-4-2-5-1	F-A-Bb-G-C-F	
C major	1-3-6-5-4-2	C-E-A-G-F-D	
G major	1-7-6-4-2-5	G-F#-E-C-A-D	
E major	1-5-6-4-2-5	E-B-C#-A-F#-B	

Inversion test: after the bass is correct, ask whether the upper voices imply the bass note is root, third, fifth, or a pedal tone. Do not rewrite the bass to match an assumed chord root.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module C - chord-quality identification from reduced voicings

16 CELLS | 96 EVENTS

HEAR QUALITY FROM THE THIRD, SEVENTH, AND ALTERED FIFTH - NOT FROM THE SHAPE NAME

Card	Source spelling	Bass	Quality answer	Clue to sing
1	C-E-G	C	major triad	3
2	C-Eb-G	C	minor triad	b3
3	C-E-G-B	C	major 7	7
4	C-E-G-Bb	C	dominant 7	3 + b7
5	C-Eb-G-Bb	C	minor 7	b3 + b7
6	B-D-F-A	B	m7b5	b3 + b5
7	G#-B-D-F	G#	dim7	b3 + b5 + bb7
8	C-E-G#	C	augmented	3 + #5
9	D-G-A	D	sus4	4, no 3
10	D-E-A	D	sus2	2, no 3
11	A-C-E-G#	A	minor-major 7	b3 + 7
12	D-F#-A-C	D	dominant 7	3 + b7
13	E-G#-B-D	E	dominant 7	3 + b7
14	F-A-C-E	F	major 7	7
15	A-C#-E-G	A	dominant 7	3 + b7

Blind pass: source player plays only root + quality-defining tones, omitting the fifth. Transcriber must identify quality before hearing the complete voicing.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module C - progression dictation and Roman-numeral reconstruction

8 PROGRESSIONS | 64 CHORD EVENTS

Card 1 - tonal frame: C major

SOURCE: C-Am-F-G | C-G/B-Am-G

ANSWER: I-vi-IV-V | I-V6-vi-V

Card 2 - tonal frame: G major

SOURCE: G-D-Em-C | Am-D-G-G

ANSWER: I-V-vi-IV | ii-V-I-I

Card 3 - tonal frame: D major

SOURCE: D-Bm-G-A | Em-A-D-D

ANSWER: I-vi-IV-V | ii-V-I-I

Card 4 - tonal frame: A minor

SOURCE: Am-F-C-G | Dm-E-Am-Am

ANSWER: i-VI-III-VII | iv-V-i-i

Card 5 - tonal frame: E minor

SOURCE: Em-C-G-D | Am-B-Em-Em

ANSWER: i-VI-III-VII | iv-V-i-i

Card 6 - tonal frame: F major

SOURCE: F-Dm-Bb-C | Gm-C-F-F

ANSWER: I-vi-IV-V | ii-V-I-I

Card 7 - tonal frame: C major -> G

SOURCE: C-Am-D7-G | Em-A7-D7-G

ANSWER: I-vi-V/G-I/G | vi/G-V/V-V-I

Card 8 - tonal frame: A minor -> C

SOURCE: Am-Dm-G-C | F-Dm-E-Am

ANSWER: i-iv-V/C-I/C | IV/C-ii/C-V/i-i

Three-listen limit for the first pass: Listen 1 = form and bass; Listen 2 = quality; Listen 3 = verify cadence. Extra loops begin only after an answer has been written.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module D - rhythm-cell vocabulary before dictation

16 CELLS | 64 CONTACTS

CLAP THE CELL, SPEAK THE GRID, THEN PLAY ONE MUTED STRING

Name	Grid / mnemonic	Write from memory
Quarter	1---2---3---4---	
Eighths	1-&-2-&-3-&-4-&-	
Backbeat	----2-------4---	
3+3+2	1--a--&-3--a--&-	
Push &4	1---2---3---4-P-	
Late a4	1---2---3---4--P	
16th stab	P-x-P-x-P-x-P-x-	
Funk 1	P-x--x-P-x--x-P-	
Tie &2	P---P-~~----P---	
Tie bar	P---P---P---P-~~	
Stop time	P-------P-------	
Shuffle	P--P P--P P--P P--P	
Quintuplet	P-P-P-P-P	
Septuplet	P-P-P-P-P-P-P	
5/4 3+2	P--P--P-P-	

Source-player variation: choose any two cells, concatenate them, and play the result four times. Transcriber writes attacks first, then rests/ties, then accents.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module D - one- and two-bar rhythm dictation

16 DICTATIONS | 64 CONTACTS

TRANSCRIBE CONTACTS FIRST; IDENTIFY PITCH OR CHORD ONLY AFTER THE RHYTHM IS STABLE

Dictation 1

```
P---P---P---P---
```

Dictation 2

```
P-P-P-P-P-P-P-P-
```

Dictation 3

```
P-x-P-x-P-x-P-x-
```

Dictation 4

```
P---P-~~----P---
```

Dictation 5

```
P-x--x-P-x--x-P-
```

Dictation 6

```
----P-------P---
```

Dictation 7

```
P--P--P-P--P--P-
```

Dictation 8

```
P---P---P---P--P
```

Dictation 9

```
P-x-P---P-x-P---
```

Dictation 16

```
P---P---|----P--P
```

Dictation 11

```
P--xP---P--xP---
```

Dictation 12

```
P---x---P---x---
```

Dictation 13

```
P--P P--P P--P P--P
```

Dictation 14

```
PP---P--PP---P--
```

Dictation 15

```
P-x---P-P-x---P-
```

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module E - interval, contour, and scale-degree hearing

12 MELODIC CELLS | 48 TONES

SING THE CONTOUR FIRST; NAME EXACT PITCHES SECOND

Context	Degree contour	Pitch answer	Sing before playing
C major	1-2-3-5	C-D-E-G	
C major	5-3-2-1	G-E-D-C	
G major	1-3-5-6	G-B-D-E	
D major	5-6-3-2	A-B-F#-E	
A minor	1-b3-5-b7	A-C-E-G	
A minor	5-4-b3-1	E-D-C-A	
E minor	1-2-b3-5	E-F#-G-B	
D minor	b3-4-5-1	F-G-A-D	
A harmonic minor	5-b6-7-1	E-F-G#-A	
A melodic minor	5-6-7-1	E-F#-G#-A	
C major	7-1-3-2	B-C-E-D	
G7	3-b7-5-1	B-F-D-G	

Contour-only pass: write U, D, or S for each move before naming a single note. Exact pitch is added only after the directional shape is correct.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module E - structural melodic targets versus ornamental notes

12 PHRASES | 48 TARGET EVENTS

THE LONGEST, STRONGEST, OR CADENTIAL NOTE IS NOT ALWAYS THE FIRST NOTE PLAYED

Chord	Source phrase	Structural target	Role
Cmaj7	D-E-G-E	E	3
G7	A-G-F-B	B	3
Am7	B-C-E-G	C	b3
Dm7	E-F-A-C	F	b3
E7	G-G#-B-D	G#	3
A7	C-C#-E-G	C#	3
Cmaj7	F-E-D-C	C	R
Gmaj7	A-F#-G-B	F#	7
Bm7b5	C#-D-F-A	D	b3
D7#11	G#-A-F#-C	G#	#11
E7b13	C-B-G#-D	C	b13
G#7alt	A-C-F#-G#	C	3 as B#

Verification: delete all non-target notes. If the remaining line no longer communicates the chord movement, the wrong notes were labeled structural.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module F - form reconstruction from repetition and landmarks

8 FORM MAPS | 64 SECTION EVENTS

COUNT FIRST; NAME SECTIONS ONLY AFTER REPEATED MATERIAL HAS BEEN IDENTIFIED

Card	Observed bar groups	One plausible form label	Landmark notes
A	4-8-4-8-4	Intro / Verse / Pre / Chorus / Outro	
B	8-8-8-8	A / A / B / A	
C	4-8-8-4	Intro / Verse / Chorus / Outro	
D	8-4-8-8-4	Verse / Pre / Chorus / Bridge / Outro	
E	4-8-4-8-8	Intro / Verse / Pre / Chorus / Solo	
F	8-8-4-8	Verse / Chorus / Bridge / Chorus	
G	4-8-4-8-8-4	Intro / Verse / Pre / Chorus / Solo / Outro	
H	8-8-8-8-8	A / A / B / Solo-A / A	

Do not force pop-section names onto every source. A/B/C labels are valid when the musical function is uncertain. Repetition structure is more important than vocabulary.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module H - arrangement reconstruction: register, texture, dynamics, and role

8 ARRANGEMENT CARDS | 96 EVENTS

TRANSCRIBE WHAT THE GUITAR IS DOING IN THE ENSEMBLE, NOT ONLY WHICH NOTES IT PLAYS

Card	Register	Dynamic	Texture	Role	Cue / fill
1	low	p	palm-muted 8ths	foundation	no fills
2	mid	mp	open triads	comping	fill on &4
3	high	mf	shell stabs	counterline	beats 2/4
4	wide	f	full chords	chorus comp	16ths
5	low+high	mf	bass + upper dyad	hybrid role	call/answer
6	high	p	single-note motif	lead	long rests
7	mid	mf->f	rising triads	build	density increases
8	all	f->pp	quarters to whole	outro	density falls

Blind arrangement test: source performer keeps the chord progression fixed and changes only one column. Transcriber identifies which arrangement variable changed.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module G - layered 16-bar transcription lab: source card

SOURCE PLAYER ONLY | TRANSCRIBER COVERS THIS PAGE

RECORD ONCE OR HAVE A PARTNER PERFORM; DO NOT STUDY THE SOURCE BEFORE TRANSCRIBING

Bar	Chord	Bass	Rhythm clue	Melodic layer	Arrangement
1	Cmaj7	C	whole-note swell	E-G-B-E	mp / high triad
2	Am7	A	whole-note swell	C-E-G-C	mp
3	Dm7	D	quarters	F-A-C-A	mp
4	G7	G	&4 anticipation	B-D-F-B	mf
5	Cmaj7	C	8th partials	E-G-E-D	p / low-mid
6	G/B	B	8th partials	D-G-B-D	p
7	Am7	A	8th partials	C-E-G-E	p
8	Em7	E	8th partials	G-B-D-B	p
9	Fmaj7	F	quarters -> 8ths	A-C-E-C	mp
10	C/E	E	quarters -> 8ths	G-C-E-G	mp
11	Dm7	D	quarters -> 8ths	F-A-C-D	mf
12	G7	G	push &4	B-F-D-B	mf
13	Cmaj7	C	16th comp	E-G-B-G	f / upper
14	G7	G	16th comp	B-D-F-D	f
15	Am7	A	16th comp	C-E-G-E	f

Source-player instruction: keep tempo steady at a comfortable rate. Perform the written melodic layer above the chord/bass information, but do not exaggerate the target notes.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module G - layered 16-bar transcription lab: reconstruction worksheet

7 PASSES | 128 WRITTEN EVENTS

COMPLETE ONE ROW FOR ALL 16 BARS BEFORE MOVING TO THE NEXT ROW

Layer	Bars 1-4	Bars 5-8	Bars 9-12	Bars 13-16
FORM / section				
BASS roots				
CHORD quality				
RHYTHM cell				
MELODIC targets				
REGISTER / texture				
DYNAMICS / cues				

Confidence code for every block: 0 = guess; 1 = plausible; 2 = confirmed by repetition or multiple clues. Re-listen first to confidence-0 blocks, not to the entire excerpt.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module G - 16-bar lab verification and reconstruction score

CHECK ONLY AFTER THE WORKSHEET IS COMPLETE

GRADE LAYERS SEPARATELY; A CORRECT CHORD NAME DOES NOT REPAIR A WRONG RHYTHM

Bars	Harmony	Bass	Rhythm	Arrangement
1-4	Cmaj7 | Am7 | Dm7 | G7	C-A-D-G	swell / swell / qtr / push	high -> rising
5-8	Cmaj7 | G/B | Am7 | Em7	C-B-A-E	8th partials	low-mid / p

Layer score

- [ ] Form / repetition 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Bass motion 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Chord quality 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Rhythm 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Melodic targets 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Arrangement 0 / 1 / 2

Verification passes

- [ ] Roots only
- [ ] Guide tones only
- [ ] Rhythm on muted strings
- [ ] Melody without chords
- [ ] Full reconstruction
- [ ] Compare to source

A disagreement is classified before correction: FORM error, BASS error, QUALITY error, RHYTHM error, MELODY error, or ARRANGEMENT error. Correct only the faulty layer, then replay the complete block to make sure the repair did not damage a previously correct layer.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module I - independent verification methods and error isolation

VERIFY WITH MORE THAN ONE CLUE

A TRANSCRIPTION IS STRONGEST WHEN DIFFERENT TESTS CONVERGE ON THE SAME ANSWER

Sing-back

Can you sing the bass or target note away from the guitar?

Root-only playback

Does the form still make harmonic sense with all extensions removed?

Guide-tone playback

Do thirds and sevenths explain the quality and cadence?

Muted-rhythm pass

Does the groove survive after all pitches are removed?

Slow playback

Does reduced speed confirm attacks without changing pitch center?

Octave check

Is the note class right but the register wrong?

Neighbor test

Do adjacent frets sound less stable than the chosen pitch?

Section comparison

Does the repeated chorus really repeat, or is bar 4/8 different?

Bass/chord split

Is the bass note an inversion under a different chord root?

Complete reconstruction

Can you perform the part continuously in time?

Do not use tablature found online as the first verification method. Compare after your independent reconstruction; otherwise the exercise becomes chart reading rather than transcription.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module J - 32-bar ear-led capstone: source-performance card

SOURCE PLAYER ONLY | 32 BARS

THE TRANSCRIBER SHOULD RECEIVE ONLY AUDIO AND A COUNT-IN

Bars	Section	Harmony	Rhythm	Texture	Dynamic
1-4	Intro	Gmaj7 | Em7 | Am7 | D7	whole / quarters	high triads	mp
5-12	Verse	Gmaj7 | D/F# | Em7 | Bm7 | Cmaj7 | G/B | Am7 | D7	8th partials	low-mid	p
13-16	Pre	Em7 | Bm7 | Cmaj7 | D7	qtr -> 8th	rising	mp->mf
17-24	Chorus	Gmaj7 | D7 | Em7 | Cmaj7 | Gmaj7 | D7 | Cmaj7 | D7	16th comp	upper/open	f
25-28	Bridge	Em7 | Cmaj7 | Gmaj7 | A7	3+3+2	wide	mf

Performance details to include

Bar 12 pushes D7 on & of 4. Bar 16 has a one-beat fill on beat 4. Bar 24 leaves beat 4 silent before the bridge. Bar 28 uses A7 as V/V into D7. Final Gmaj7 sustains through bar 32.

Source player may embellish lightly, but structural bass, chord quality, rhythm family, and section lengths must remain unchanged.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module J - 32-bar capstone reconstruction sheets

FORM -> BASS -> HARMONY -> RHYTHM -> MELODY -> ARRANGEMENT

DO NOT LOOK AT THE SOURCE CARD UNTIL ALL CONFIDENCE-0 BLOCKS HAVE BEEN RE-LISTENED

Bars	Form	Bass path	Harmony	Rhythm	Texture / dyn.
1-4					
5-8					
9-12					
13-16					
17-20					
21-24					
25-28					

Landmarks to mark

First tonic, first dominant, first repeated section, loudest section, modulation or secondary dominant, final tonic.

Confidence map

Circle each 4-bar block: 0 = uncertain, 1 = plausible, 2 = independently verified. Repair 0s before polishing 1s.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Module J - reconstruction, comparison, and recovery ladder

AUDIO -> YOUR CHART -> YOUR PERFORMANCE -> SOURCE COMPARISON

THE GOAL IS NOT A PERFECT COPY OF EVERY ORNAMENT; IT IS A CORRECT STRUCTURAL RECONSTRUCTION

Pass	Performance reduction	What must survive
Pass 1	Clap / count only	Form and pulse
Pass 2	Roots only	Bass and section landmarks
Pass 3	Shells / triads	Chord quality and function
Pass 4	Muted rhythm	Exact attack / rest / tie grid
Pass 5	Structural melody	Targets and contour
Pass 6	Arrangement	Register, texture, dynamics, cues

Recovery during the take

- [ ] Keep the pulse
- [ ] Find active bar
- [ ] Return to root or shell
- [ ] Rejoin known rhythm cell
- [ ] Restore arrangement at next section
- [ ] Review only after ending

Comparison categories

- [ ] Form 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Bass 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Harmony 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Rhythm 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Melodic targets 0 / 1 / 2
- [ ] Arrangement 0 / 1 / 2

Structural pass standard: at least 10/12 across the six categories, with no zero in form, bass, harmony, or rhythm.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 76

Level 76 mastery gate, transcription log, and Section X direction

PASS = INDEPENDENT EAR-LED RECONSTRUCTION

THE END PRODUCT IS A PLAYABLE ARRANGEMENT YOU CREATED FROM LISTENING

Mastery gate

- [ ] Identify tonic before using the fretboard.
- [ ] Transcribe twelve bass routes with inversion awareness.
- [ ] Identify all sixteen chord-quality cards.
- [ ] Write all rhythm dictations from audio.
- [ ] Extract structural melodic targets from twelve phrases.
- [ ] Reconstruct the 16-bar layered lab.
- [ ] Reconstruct and perform the 32-bar capstone.

Two-day standard

On two separate days, reconstruct an unfamiliar 16-32 bar excerpt without a supplied chart. Score the result across form, bass, harmony, rhythm, melody, and arrangement.

PASS: 10/12 or better, with no zero in form, bass, harmony, or rhythm. Then perform the reconstructed arrangement without stopping.

Transcription log

Date	Source / length	Form	Bass	Harmony	Rhythm	Melody	Arrange.	Score

Next level

Level 77 will turn transcription into active ear training: interval recognition, chord-function hearing, sung guide tones, melodic dictation, call-and-response reproduction, and instant fretboard realization without searching.

SECTION X DIRECTION: continue integrating existing vocabulary into hearing, performance, and musical decision-making rather than adding new scale systems for their own sake.